

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 3 · Imperialism & World War I (1890–1920) · US.19–US.27

Match the task to the tool — then
teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put events in order / show change over time	● Timeline	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes cause across time. <i>Builds SSP.05 chronology.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO (or OPTIC)	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national history stick — and it's what sets History Hack apart. Our signature move.

SSP Crosswalk

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

Which organizer builds which practice — and where it lives in Unit 3

Every organizer in this toolkit is also a **skills tool**. Use this crosswalk to name the Tennessee Social Studies Practice you're building — and to pick the organizer that builds it best.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO	BUILD IT WITH	USE IT WHEN · WHERE IN UNIT 3
SSP.01 Collect Information	Gather facts from primary & secondary sources.	5 Ws Main Idea & Details K-W-L	Intake: pulling the who/what/when and key ideas out of a reading, image, or lecture.
SSP.02 Critically Examine Sources	Interrogate a source: author, audience, point of view, purpose, reliability.	HIPPO C-E-R	Any primary source in US.19–US.27 — a yellow-journalism cartoon, the Zimmermann Telegram, or Wilson's speech.
SSP.03 Synthesize Data	Organize & combine data from several sources into one picture.	Comparison matrix Concept web Main Idea	US.22 (three diplomacies) & US.26 (home front) — holding many cases against one yardstick.
SSP.04 Construct & Communicate with Evidence	Build and defend an argument or explanation with evidence.	C-E-R T-chart Problem–Solution	US.20 (interventionists vs. non-interventionists) & US.27 (join the League?) — take a stance.
SSP.05 Develop Historical Awareness	Sequence in time, trace cause & effect, and see change over time.	Timeline Cause & Effect Concept web	US.21 (war → new empire) & US.24 (the road to war, 1917).
SSP.06 Develop Geographic Awareness	Read place, region & spatial patterns; connect geography to events.	Territory matrix ★ Tennessee Connection	US.21 (overseas territories) & US.25 (the Western Front) — and every Tennessee Connection.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Compare 2 Things

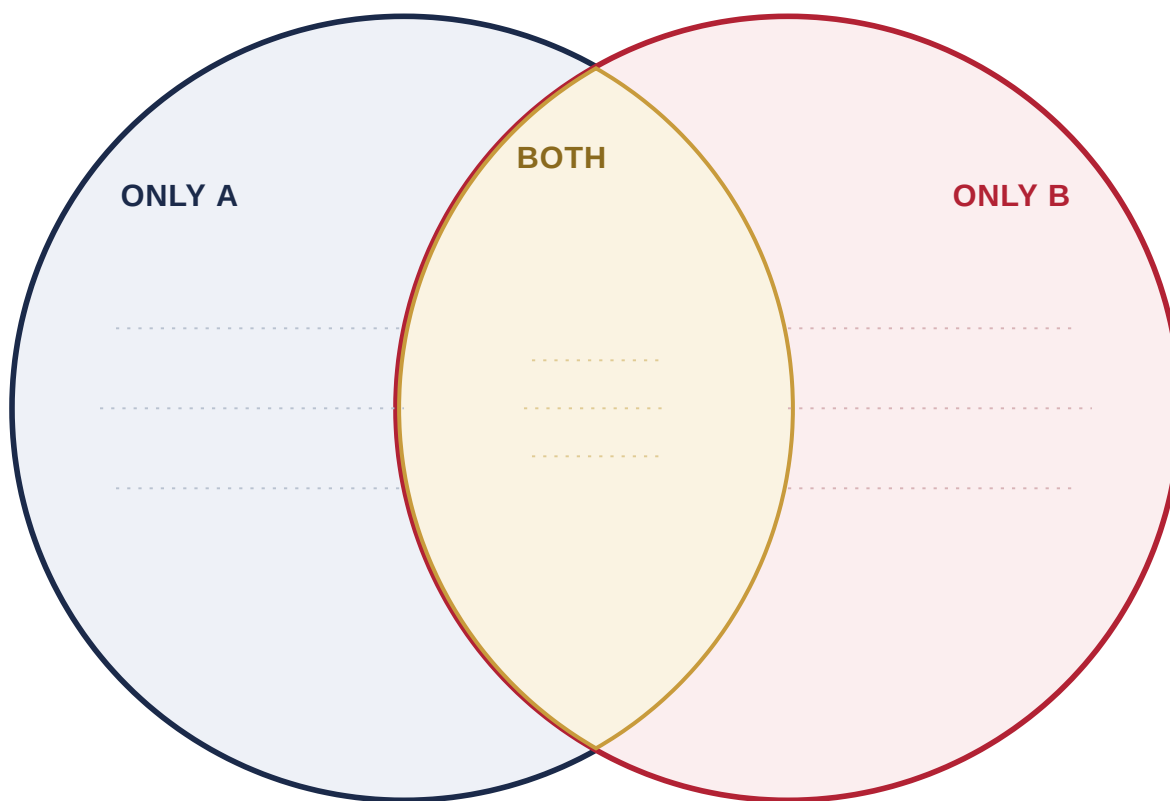
DOK 2 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare two** things — the overlap makes shared traits visible and forces precise differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

In each circle, write what is unique to that topic. In the middle, write what they share.

Topic A: _____

Topic B: _____



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and a sentence starter: "Both ____ and ____ are ____." Let pairs fill the BOTH region first.

EXTEND

Rank the differences: which one matters most, and why? Defend it in one sentence of evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

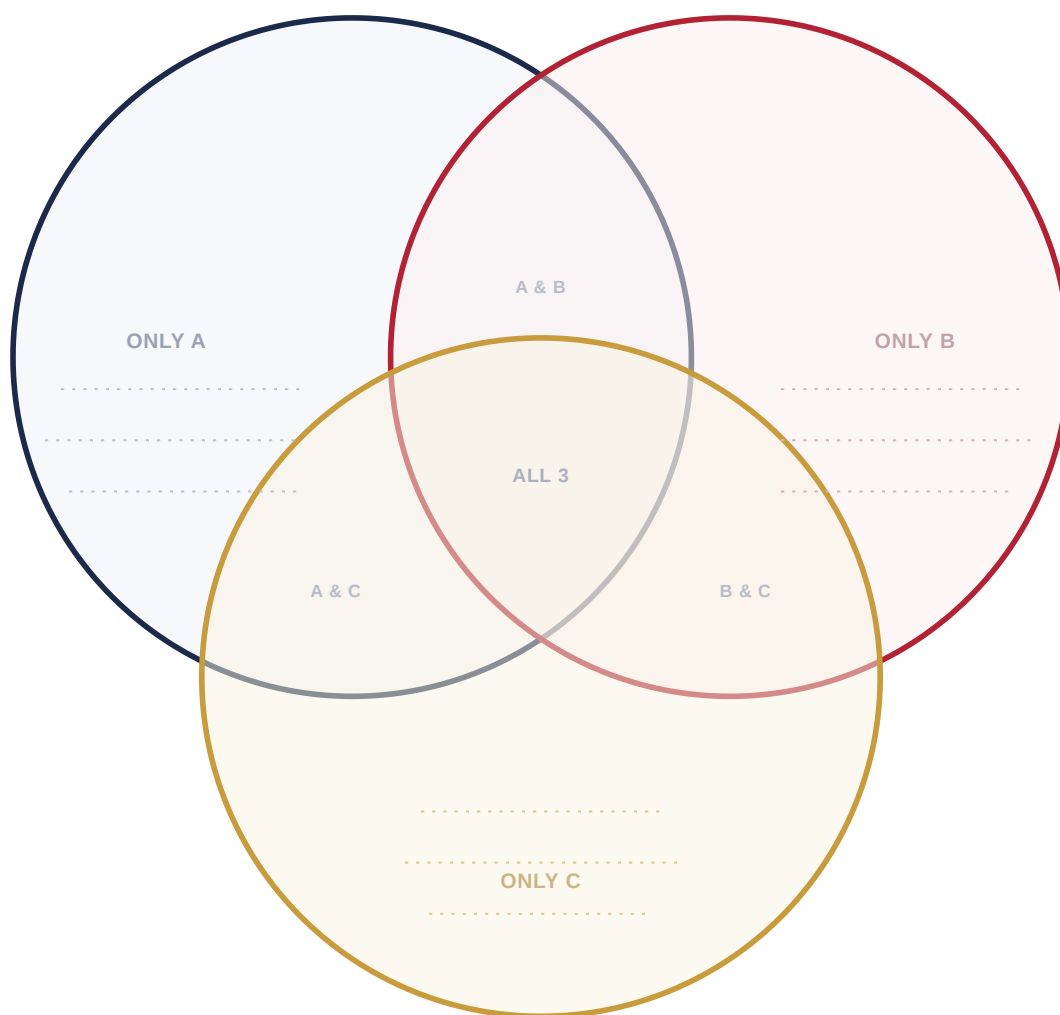
Compare 3

DOK 2-3 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare three** things at once — the overlaps expose what is shared by two, what is shared by all three, and what stays unique. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each topic in the key, then fill the circles: unique traits in the single lobes, shared traits where they overlap.

○ Topic A: _____ ○ Topic B: _____ ○ Topic C: _____



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and start with the ALL 3 center: "All three share ____." Let pairs fill one lobe at a time.

EXTEND

Argue which topic is the "odd one out" and defend it with one trait from its unique lobe.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

🕒 10-15 min

Compare 2

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **two** things head-to-head on points you choose, lining up each trait side-by-side so real differences stand out. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

[illegible]

Synthesis — the most important difference, and why it matters

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the two columns with sticky notes.

Compare · Contrast Matrix

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Compare 3+ on criteria

DOK 2–3 · Analysis

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **three or more** things across several named criteria at once, so patterns across the whole set become visible. *Comparing on structured criteria — identifying similarities & differences — is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each option across the top and each criterion down the side. Fill every box with what that option shows for that criterion. Then name the pattern you see.

CRITERIA ↓ OPTIONS →	Option A	Option B	Option C
CRITERION 1			
CRITERION 2			
CRITERION 3			

Pattern · conclusion — what the whole matrix tells you

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SCAFFOLD
Pre-name one or two criteria and a starter:
“On ___, Option A ___ while Option C ___.” Complete one row as a class.

EXTEND
In the conclusion, explain *why* the pattern holds — what causes options to line up or split the way they do?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** symbols in cells, or **build** the grid with cards.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Causes / Effects

SSP.05 · DOK 2–3

WHEN · WHY Use when a task asks **what led to** an event and **what followed** from it — separating causes from effects builds reasoning about change over time. *Analyzing cause & effect is a core TN Social Studies Practice (SSP.05).*

List what led to the event on the left, then what followed from it on the right. Arrows show the flow: causes → event → effects.

CAUSES · WHAT LED TO IT	THE EVENT	EFFECTS · WHAT FOLLOWED
Cause 1	EVENT / TOPIC NAME THE EVENT OR DECISION	Effect 1
Cause 2		Effect 2
Cause 3		Effect 3

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SCAFFOLD

Offer sentence frames: “Because ____, the event happened,” and “As a result, ____.” Fill the event box first.

EXTEND

Rank the causes from most to least important, or trace one effect into a new cause (a chain).

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** arrows/icons, or **build** it with cards.

Timeline — Order & Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Order / sequence

SSP.05 • Chronology

WHEN • WHY Use to put events in **order** and see how things **change over time** — the vertical spine makes sequence and distance between events visible. *Chronological reasoning — ordering events and tracking change — is a core practice (TN Social Studies Practices SSP.05).*

Order the events from earliest (top) to latest (bottom). On each line, write the date on the left, then what happened on the right.

▲ EARLIEST

ORDER • CHANGE OVER TIME

DATE / WHEN

1

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

2

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

3

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

4

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

5

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS



LATEST / MOST RECENT

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards and have students **physically sequence** them before writing. Sentence starter: "First ____, then ____, and finally ____."

EXTEND

Mark the moment of biggest **change**. Explain in one sentence what caused it and what it changed.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** dates, **say** the sequence aloud, **draw** an icon per event, or **build** the line with cards.

Concept Web

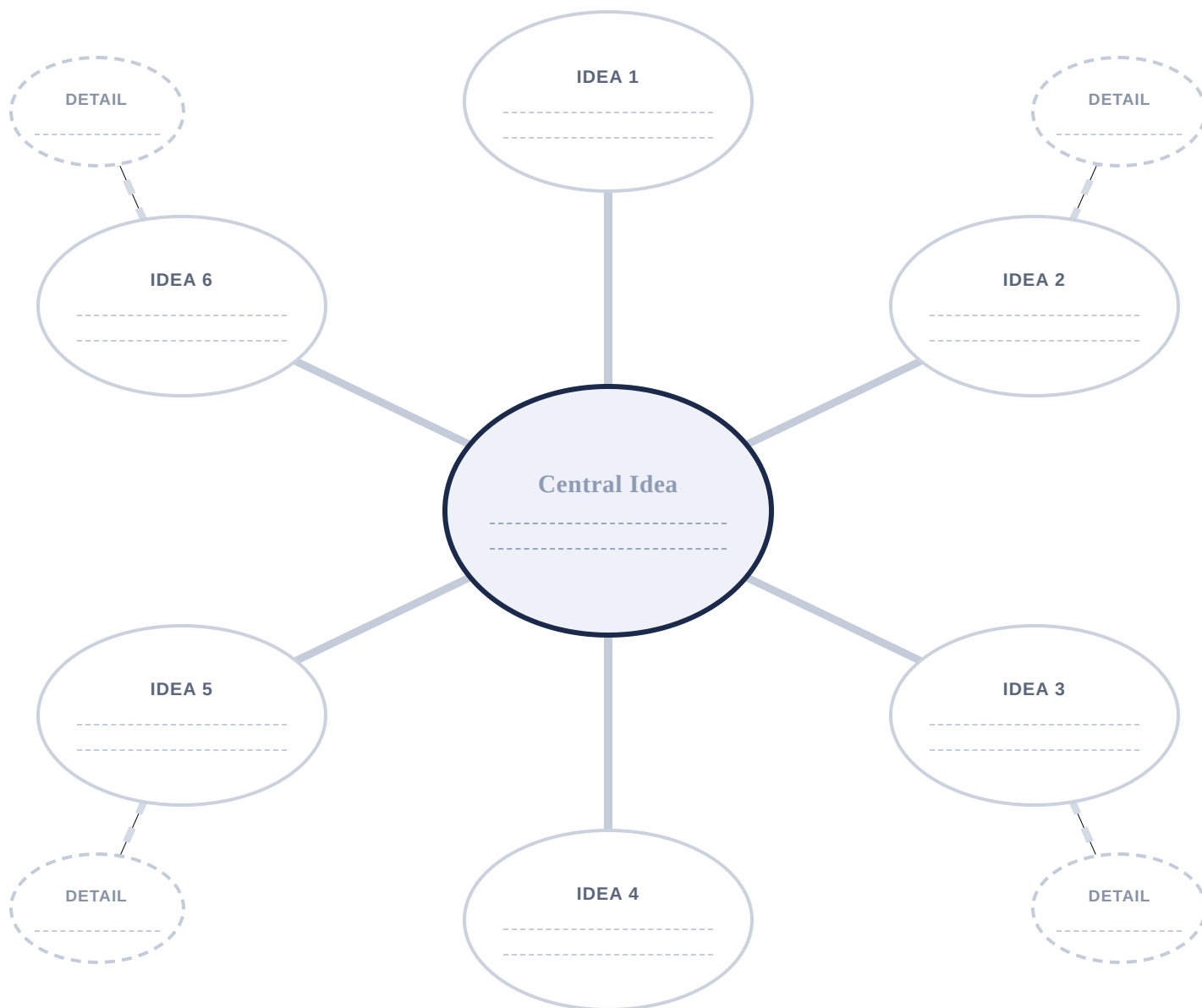
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Brainstorm / connect

DOK 2 • Relationships

WHEN • WHY Use to **brainstorm** around a central concept and show how ideas branch and **connect** to it. The hub-and-spoke shape makes relationships between ideas visible at a glance. *Organizing ideas into a nonlinear web supports schema-building (UDL 3.0).*

Write the big idea in the center. On each outer bubble, add an idea that connects to it — then use the small bubbles for a supporting detail.



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SCAFFOLD

Seed two bubbles for students and give a linking stem: "This connects to the center because ____."

EXTEND

Draw new lines **between** outer bubbles that relate to each other and label what the link is.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons in bubbles, or **build** it with sticky notes.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Summarize

DOK 2 · Main Idea

WHEN · WHY Use to pull the **central point** out of a text or lecture and anchor it to the details and evidence that support it.
Summarizing — keeping the main idea and cutting the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).

Write the main idea at the top. In each box below, add a detail or piece of evidence that supports it — the arrows show every detail holding the main idea up. Then say it all in one sentence.

MAIN IDEA

↑ THESE DETAILS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Detail 4

Summary — the whole thing in one sentence

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give a main-idea frame: "This is mostly about ____ because ____." Fill one detail box together before students work.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support, or add a detail that would *weaken* the main idea.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon per detail, or **build** it with labeled cards.

🕒 10-15 min

Activate + track

DOK 1–2 · Metacognition

Before you start, fill K and W. After learning, complete L — then compare it to what you wanted to know.

TOPIC _____

[illegible]

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Fill **K** as a whole class on chart paper first.
Give question stems for **W**: "I wonder ____"
/ "How does ____?"

In **L**, mark which of your **W** questions got answered — and write one new question you still have.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** what they know and learned in each column.

5 Ws — Who • What • When • Where • Why

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Use to quickly capture the **essential facts** of an event — who, what, when, where, and why (plus how). The hub-and-spoke keeps every key question in view at once. *Establishing the who/what/when/where anchors chronological reasoning (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Name the event in the center, then answer each spoke to capture the essential facts. (Use How to stretch to six.)

WHO • PEOPLE

WHAT • HAPPENED

WHEN • TIME

WHERE • PLACE

WHY • REASON

HOW • THE WAY

EVENT / TOPIC • NAME IT HERE

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SCAFFOLD

Provide sentence stems for each spoke:
 “This happened because ____,” “It took place in ____.”

EXTEND

Turn the six facts into a one-sentence summary, or rank which W matters most for understanding the event.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** the spokes with cards.

WHEN · WHY Use to define a **problem**, weigh two or three possible solutions against their likely results, and justify the best choice with evidence. *Generating & testing possible solutions is a high-yield reasoning strategy (Marzano); it builds cause-effect thinking (TN SSP.05).*

State the problem, map 2–3 possible solutions with their likely results, then choose the best one and justify it. Follow the arrows: problem → options → decision.

PROBLEM — what is wrong, and for whom?

WEIGH THE OPTIONS

Possible Solution 1	Possible Solution 2	Possible Solution 3
Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off

DECIDE

Best solution + justification — I chose ____ because...

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Provide the problem and one solution; students supply the rest. Offer a starter: “If we ____, then ____ because ____.”

EXTEND
Add a second criterion (cost *and* fairness) and explain a trade-off you are willing to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** the flow, or **build** the options with cards and vote.

🕒 10-15 min

Learn a term

WHEN · WHY Use to build **deep word knowledge** — not just a definition, but traits, examples, and non-examples that sharpen the boundary of a concept. *Contrasting examples with non-examples strengthens concept learning (Marzano — similarities & differences).*

2. CHARACTERISTICS / FACTS

4. NON-EXAMPLES

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon for each example, or **build** the quadrants with sticky notes.

Claim • Evidence • Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Make a claim

DOK 3 • Argument

WHEN • WHY Use to build an **evidence-based argument** — a defensible claim, the evidence that supports it, and the reasoning that ties them together. *Constructing arguments from evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

State your claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning — how the evidence proves the claim.

CLAIM — my answer to the question

BACKED BY



EVIDENCE — facts, quotes & details that prove it

1

2

3

WHICH PROVES



REASONING — this evidence supports my claim because...

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SCAFFOLD

Give a claim frame: “___ because ___.” and a reasoning starter: “This shows ___ because ___.” Fill just one evidence box first.

EXTEND

Add a **counterclaim** and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record) the argument, or **build** it from evidence cards before writing.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Analyze a source

DOK 3 • Sourcing

WHEN • WHY Use to **interrogate a primary source** so students read like historians — questioning context, audience, point of view, and purpose instead of taking it at face value. *Sourcing and contextualizing evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Cite the source, then interrogate it — read it like a historian, one H-I-P-P-O question at a time.

SOURCE — title / author / date

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT *What was happening at the time?*

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE *Who was it made for?*

P

POINT OF VIEW *Who made it — what is their bias / perspective?*

P

PURPOSE *Why was it made? What did they want?*

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION *What do you already know that connects?*

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SCAFFOLD

Model one letter aloud with the class first. Provide a question stem per box and let partners discuss before writing.

EXTEND

Rank the five letters: which one most changes how you should **trust** this source, and why?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write, say** (record) their analysis, or **annotate** the source directly.

Tennessee Connection

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Local ↔ National

DOK 3 • Connect

WHEN • WHY History sticks when it comes home. This organizer links a national event to a Tennessee person, place, or law — then asks students to argue why the local story matters. *Relevance and personal connection drive engagement and retention (UDL 3.0).*

Zoom in: link the national story to Tennessee — then say why the local story matters.

National topic / standard: _____

THE NATIONAL STORY

WHAT HAPPENED ACROSS THE U.S.?

THE TENNESSEE STORY

A TN PERSON, PLACE, OR LAW



THE LINK — how does the Tennessee story connect to the national one?

WHY THE LOCAL STORY MATTERS — why should Tennesseans know this?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide the TN name/place and one national fact; students write only the *link* sentence: "This connects because ____."

EXTEND

Argue whether the Tennessee example is typical of the nation or an exception — and what that tells us.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** the link aloud, **draw** a map line from TN to the nation, or **build** it as a matching pair.

Why the U.S. Looked Outward

⌚ 15-20 min

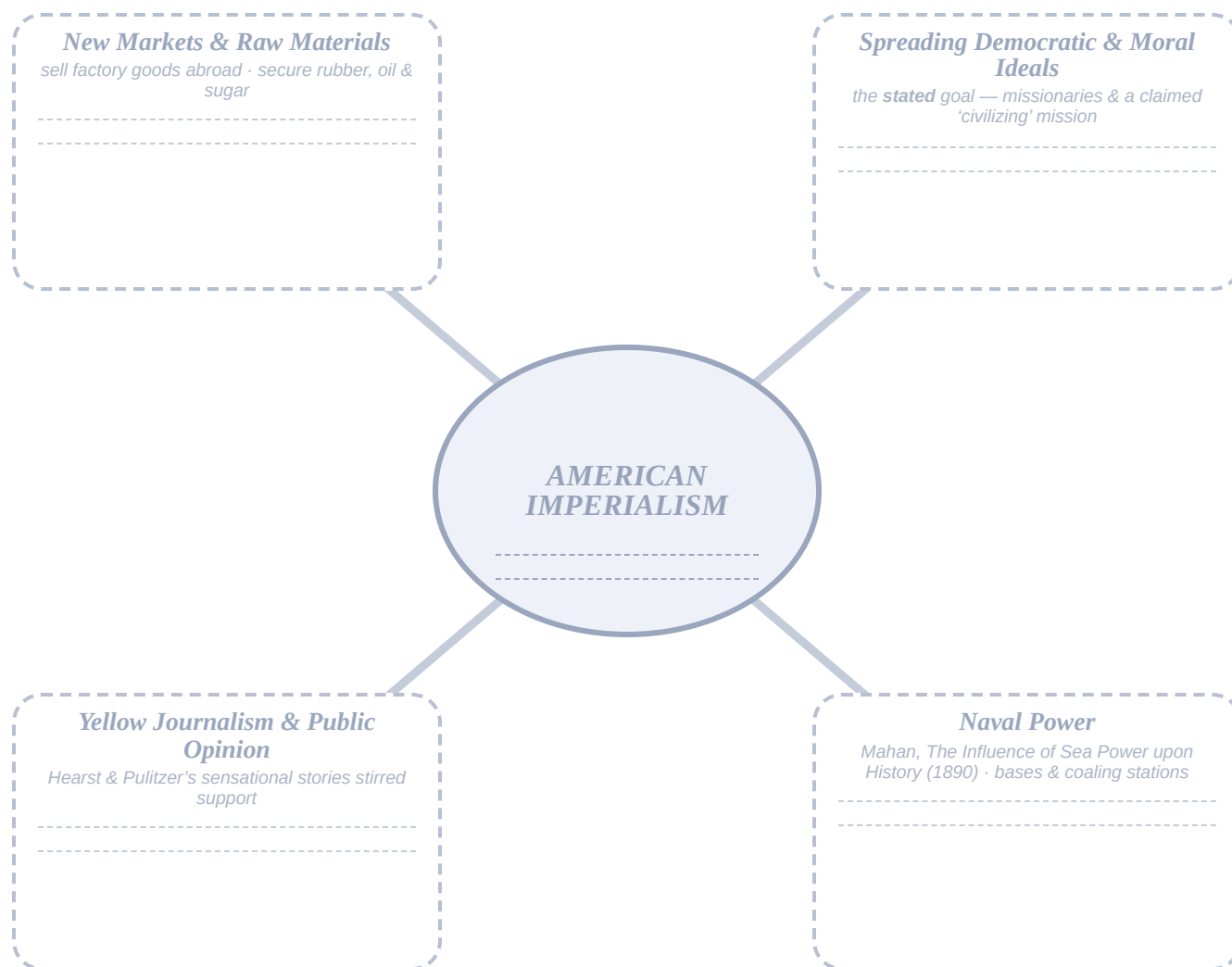
Concept Web

DOK 2 • Causation

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A concept web surfaces the several **drivers** that converged on one outcome — American imperialism — and makes their relationships visible at a glance. *Mapping multiple causes onto a single effect is core causal reasoning (TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05).*

The hub names the outcome. On each spoke, add evidence for a driver that pushed the U.S. to look outward — then draw links between drivers that reinforced each other.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Word bank on the board: **markets & raw materials** · **stated democratic/moral ideals** · **yellow journalism** · **naval power**. Fill one spoke together with a linking stem: "This drove expansion because ____."

EXTEND

Rank the four drivers — which mattered most in pushing the U.S. outward, and why? Defend it with one piece of evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** an icon in each bubble.

Should the U.S. Expand Overseas?

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

T-Chart • Weigh Two Sides

DOK 3 • Argument

WHEN • WHY Interventionists and non-interventionists clashed over whether the U.S. should reach beyond its borders. A T-chart forces a decision that rests on evidence from **both** sides, weighed on the same lenses. *Constructing and communicating an argument from evidence is a TN Social Studies Practice (SSP.04).*

Weigh both sides on the same three lenses. Gather evidence in each light box — then take your own position on the line at the bottom.

	INTERVENTIONISTS expand U.S. power overseas	NON-INTERVENTIONISTS Anti-Imperialist League • hold back
Political power & self-government?	<i>great-power status & global influence</i> 	<i>violates self-government & the consent of the governed</i>
Economic cost vs. gain?	<i>opens new markets & sources of resources</i> 	<i>costly wars & colonies to defend and administer</i>
Moral whose ideals?	<i>the stated goal of spreading democracy & "uplift"</i> 	<i>contradicts America's own founding ideals</i>

Your stance — Should the U.S. expand overseas? _____ because _____

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SCAFFOLD

Sentence starters: "One reason to intervene is ____." and "One reason to hold back is ____." Fill the Political row together first.

EXTEND

Argue the side you personally **disagree** with, using only evidence from its column — then name the strongest counter-argument.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** their cells, **say** a position aloud, or **debate** it in pairs before writing the verdict.

The Spanish-American War & a New American Empire

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN · WHY Laying the chain out as **cause** → **event** → **effect** makes visible how the war of 1898 grew from Cuban independence, the press, and the *Maine* — and reshaped America's role in the world. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Three causes pushed toward war on the left; four outcomes flowed out on the right. Arrows show the chain: causes → event → effects.

CAUSES · WHAT LED TO WAR

Cuban struggle for independence from Spain

Yellow journalism — Hearst & Pulitzer

Explosion of the USS *Maine* (1898)

THE EVENT

SPANISH-AMERICAN WAR, 1898

Describe the conflict between the U.S. and Spain

OUTCOMES · A NEW AMERICAN EMPIRE

U.S. annexes Hawaii (1898)

U.S. gains Puerto Rico, Guam & the Philippines

Cuba & the Roosevelt Corollary

Philippine Insurrection — Emilio Aguinaldo

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee — the “**Volunteer State**” — sent thousands of volunteers to the **Spanish-American War of 1898**. Tennessee regiments served, continuing the state's volunteer tradition.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Word bank of the three causes: **Cuban independence** · **yellow journalism** · **USS *Maine***. Ask: which cause was the **spark**? Fill the event box first.

EXTEND

Which **outcome** most changed America's role in the world? Defend your choice with evidence from the chain.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **map** the new territories the U.S. acquired.

Three Ways to Lead in the World

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A matrix holds several cases against one yardstick, so patterns across the three diplomacies pop into view. Comparing on structured criteria — identifying similarities & differences — is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03 synthesize.

Compare the three approaches across the same four questions. The faint notes are starters — write over them in your own words, then look for the pattern.

APPROACH → CRITERIA ↓	Big Stick T. Roosevelt • 1901–1909	Dollar Taft • 1909–1913	Moral Wilson • 1913–1921
Core idea	<i>"speak softly and carry a big stick"</i>	<i>influence through American business & investment</i>	<i>reject imperialism; back democratic governments</i>
Main tool	<i>military & naval strength</i>	<i>loans & investment</i>	<i>diplomacy & moral pressure</i>
A real example	<i>Panama Canal • Roosevelt Corollary</i>	<i>Latin America & East Asia investments</i>	<i>Mexico intervention debate</i>
View of using force	<i>willing to use force</i>	<i>force as a backup</i>	<i>force only as a last resort</i>

★ **Tennessee Connection** — **Cordell Hull** of Pickett County, Tennessee served in Congress during this era; he favored international **trade agreements** over military intervention — later the longest-serving U.S. Secretary of State and a Nobel Peace Prize winner.

Your call: Which approach best fit this era? _____ **because** _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the **Core idea** row together first as the model, then let students complete the rest by column.

EXTEND

Argue which approach best fit the era — use evidence from the matrix to defend your "___ because ___" line.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, or **chart** the three side by side.

What Set the World on Fire

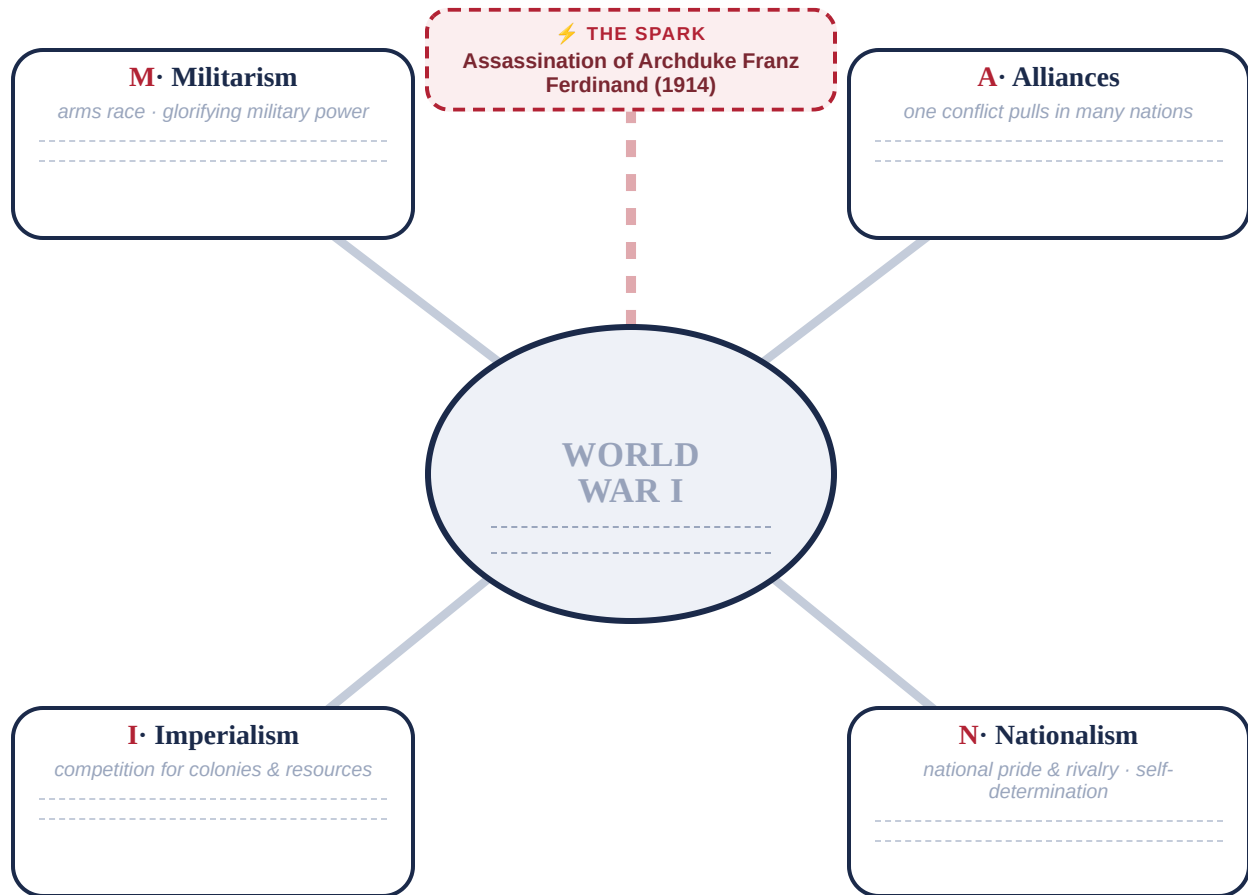
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web · M.A.I.N.

DOK 2 · Causation

WHEN · WHY The web makes the **M.A.I.N.** mnemonic visible as one system feeding the war — four long-run forces plus a single spark. *Tracing multiple causes of an event is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05 (causation).*

The hub is the war itself. On each M.A.I.N. bubble, write how that force pushed Europe toward war — the faint notes are starters. The dashed callout is the spark.



Why did the U.S. stay neutral (at first)?

geographic distance · a diverse immigrant population with ties to both sides · the tradition of avoiding “entangling alliances” · profitable trade with both sides

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SCAFFOLD

Give the **M.A.I.N.** word bank (Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, Nationalism) and fill one bubble together.

EXTEND

Which cause made the war hardest to avoid? Draw links **between** bubbles to show how the forces reinforced each other.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** an icon for each cause.

The Road to War, 1917

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2–3 • Causation

WHEN • WHY Use when several reasons **converge** on a single decision — here, four pressures leading the U.S. to declare war in April 1917. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Four separate reasons on the left converged on one decision in the center. Arrows show the flow: four reasons → one decision → first effects.

FOUR REASONS • WHAT PUSHED TOWARD WAR

Unrestricted submarine warfare

sinking of the RMS Lusitania (1915)

The Zimmermann Telegram

Germany's secret offer to Mexico

Defense of democracy

"make the world safe for democracy"

Economic ties to the Allies

loans & wartime trade

ONE DECISION

U.S. Declares War on Germany

April 1917

WHICH REASON WEIGHED MOST? WHY NOW?

THEN — THE FIRST EFFECTS

First effects • what happened next

the draft (Selective Service) and the American Expeditionary Force mobilize — add what followed ...

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Over **90,000 Tennesseans** served in World War I, and Tennessee's military camps trained thousands of soldiers for the war effort.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Which reason was the final trigger? Offer a word bank (Lusitania, Zimmermann, democracy, trade) and fill the center box first.

EXTEND

Could the U.S. have stayed neutral? Defend your answer using at least two of the four reasons.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **analyze** the Zimmermann Telegram as a primary source.

WHEN · WHY A main-idea organizer separates the **big idea** from the details and evidence that support it, so students summarize instead of listing facts. *Summarizing — keep the main idea, cut the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).*

Fill each detail box first, using the faint hints as anchors. Then infer the main idea all four developments support and write it up top — the arrows show every detail holding it up. Finish with one summary sentence.

MAIN IDEA

American troops, new tactics, and standout soldiers helped the Allies gain the advantage on the Western Front.

↑ THESE FOUR DEVELOPMENTS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Trench Warfare & New Technology

Trench warfare & No Man's Land; new weapons — machine guns, poison gas, tanks, and aircraft.

Harlem Hellfighters

The 369th Infantry Regiment — an African American unit that fought on the Western Front.

Military Leaders

Gen. John J. Pershing led the AEF; Herbert Hoover ran the Food Administration on the supply side.

Sgt. Alvin C. York

Meuse–Argonne Offensive, October 1918.

In one sentence, how did America's entry change the war?

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Alvin C. York of **Fentress County, Tennessee** became one of the most decorated American soldiers of WWI — in the Meuse–Argonne Offensive of October 1918 he helped capture 132 German soldiers.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the four detail boxes first using the faint hints, then infer the main idea together.
Frame: “All four of these show that ____.”

EXTEND
Which development mattered most to the Allied advantage? Defend your pick with evidence from the boxes.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** the boxes, **say** the main idea aloud, or **draw** an icon for each development.

WHEN · WHY A three-column matrix holds the war’s political, economic, and social ramifications against one set of questions, so students analyze change on the home front across every dimension at once. *Structured comparison across criteria is Marzano’s highest-yield strategy; SSP.03 synthesize.*

Track how the war changed life at home across three fronts. Fill the “What changed” row across all three columns first, then work down — the faint hints are anchors, not the whole answer.

	Political government & law	Economic money & mobilization	Social people & roles
What changed the big shift	Federal power expands; new limits on dissent.	The economy mobilizes for total war.	Roles at home begin to shift.
A key example name the evidence	Committee on Public Information (George Creel); Espionage & Sedition Acts; Schenck v. U.S. — a “clear and present danger.”	Voluntary rationing (“meatless / wheatless days”); Liberty / war bonds; booming war industries.	Women enter the workforce (fueling suffrage momentum); the Great Migration north.
Who was most affected the people	War critics & conscientious objectors.	Households, farmers, and war workers.	Women, African Americans, and other minorities.

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Tennessee’s home front expanded military training facilities and war industries; **Nashville, Memphis, and Chattanooga** served as training and supply hubs, and Tennessee women organized Red Cross chapters and Liberty Bond drives statewide.

Synthesize: Across all three fronts, how did World War I change life at home?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the “What changed” row across all three columns first, then work down.
Frame: “On the ____ front, the war ____.”

EXTEND
Which change had the longest-lasting effect on American life? Defend it with evidence from the matrix.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, **draw** a symbol per cell, or **chart** it on the board.

WHEN · WHY A T-chart forces a decision that rests on evidence from **both** sides of the ratification debate before students commit to a stance. *Building an argument from competing claims and evidence is SSP.04; comparing similarities and differences is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Weigh both sides of the debate over joining the League of Nations. Add reasons and evidence to each column — then take a reasoned stance of your own.

Context — Wilson's Fourteen Points (1918)

A peace plan built on **self-determination**, **free trade**, and **open diplomacy** — and **Point 14**, a **League of Nations** to keep peace through collective security.

JOIN · RATIFY

Wilson & the internationalists

- Collective security to help prevent future wars
- U.S. moral leadership in the postwar world
- Honor the peace settlement Wilson negotiated

REJECT

Sen. Henry Cabot Lodge & the reservationists

- Article X could pull the U.S. into foreign wars
- Protect Congress's power to declare war & national sovereignty
- Keep the tradition of avoiding "entangling alliances"

What actually happened · your stance

The U.S. Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles, and the United States never joined the League. Should it have? — My stance: _____ because _____

★ **Tennessee Connection** — **Cordell Hull** of Pickett County, Tennessee — serving in Congress during the League debate — later championed international cooperation as Secretary of State and helped found the United Nations.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a starter for each column: "The U.S. should join because ____" / "The U.S. should stay out because ____." Fill one reason on each side together.

EXTEND

Was rejecting the League a missed chance to prevent future war, or a wise choice to protect sovereignty? Defend either side with evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** reasons, **say** a stance aloud, **draw** a two-pan balance, or **debate** it in teams.